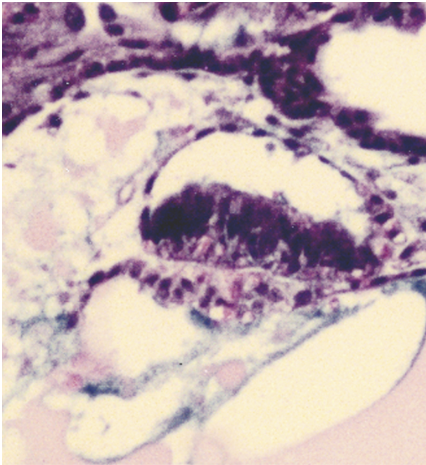




YOU ARE **4 WEEKS EXACTLY**  
252 days to go

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### YOUR BABY TODAY

This highly magnified image shows that the embryo consists of two layers of cells. Those of the upper darker layer are more rectangular in shape and lie on the side of the amniotic cavity, and those of the lower layer lie on the side of the yolk sac.

**“Are you feeling irritable and tired, and are your breasts tender?  
Well, you might just be pregnant!”**

Nature has a strange way of working. You might feel low if you have your usual PMS symptoms and think it means that you haven't conceived, but in fact, there are many similarities between PMS symptoms and those of early pregnancy. This is because the hormones that cause PMS are raised in pregnancy and so can cause the same symptoms. In addition to this, you might be irritable and emotional even without having PMS, just due to the anxiety of wanting to be pregnant and waiting to see whether or not your period arrives.

While you are in the middle of this storm of hormones and raging emotions, it can be difficult to remain calm. Talk to your partner about your emotions and anxieties—just expressing that you're finding things stressful can help you get through this tense time. Alternatively, confide in a female relative or friend, who might be able to relate to how you're feeling.

Frustratingly, at this point it is still a waiting game; all you can do is try to be patient until you take your pregnancy test. If your period was due today—day 28 of your cycle—and hasn't made an appearance, you can take a test as early as today or tomorrow. Good luck!

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### PELVIC FLOOR EXERCISES

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**It's never too early to start Kegel exercises** and you'll be glad you did once you become pregnant. The pelvic floor is a broad sling of muscles that stretches between your legs and extends from the pubic bone in front to the spine at the rear. It holds and supports your bladder, uterus, and bowel in place and controls the muscles that hold closed the anus, urethra, and vagina.

**Try these simple steps to tone your pelvic floor:**

**First** try to locate your pelvic floor; close your eyes—now visualize the sling of muscles stretching right across your body holding your uterus and bladder.